

Disaster Response &

A comparative analysis of government actions, community responses, and preparedness across different nations.

Resilience

Presentation Agenda

- **Disaster Case Studies:** A look at recent events in Japan, India, and Malaysia.
- **Q1: Similarities & Differences:** Comparing country responses.
- **Q2: Causes of Patterns:** Why these similarities and differences happen.
- **Q3: Community Resilience:** The most important element for recovery.
- **Q4: Better Preparedness:** Actionable steps for individuals and families.

Day 1 work

Disasters (Country)	People's action	Government's (not limited) action	Highlighting issues/changes after this disaster?
Great East Japan Earthquake (2011)	Orderly self-evacuation to high ground Community shelters set up Volunteers cleared debris & shared supplies	Self-Defense Forces deployed for rescue Evacuation zone around Fukushima plant Accepted international aid Criticised for slow nuclear response	Stricter nuclear safety rules Higher sea walls & revised evacuation plans National debate on nuclear energy
Kerala Floods (India, 2018)	Fishermen rescued thousands with their own boats Volunteers ran relief camps Locals donated food, clothes & supplies	~3,200 relief camps for ~1 million evacuees NDRF, Army, Navy & Air Force rescue CM Distress Relief Fund for aid Criticised for dam-release timing	Need for dam management & flood early-warning "Rebuild Kerala" initiative Fishermen honoured as "army of the sea"
Cyclone Tauktae (India, 2021)	Coastal residents moved to shelters early Fishermen returned to shore before landfall Communities helped evacuate the elderly	Large pre-landfall evacuation; NDRF pre-deployed IMD issued cyclone warnings Navy rescued workers from a sunken barge off Mumbai	Review of offshore worker safety Early-warning kept deaths relatively low Focus on coastal infrastructure resilience

Day 2 work

Disasters (Country)	People's action	Government's (not limited) action	Highlighting issues/changes after this disaster?
Uttarakhand Floods (India, 2013)	Villagers sheltered & fed stranded pilgrims Locals guided survivors to safety	Army & Air Force "Operation Rahat" helicopter rescue Relief camps for survivors Criticised for weak early-warning	Scrutiny of construction & dams on fragile slopes Better pilgrimage management Calls for Himalayan early-warning systems
Selangor Floods (Malaysia, 2021)	Evacuated to shelters Helped neighbours Shared food and supplies	Conducted rescue operations Opened evacuation centres Provided relief and financial aid	Improved flood warning systems Upgraded drainage systems Increased disaster preparedness
Noto Peninsula Earthquake (Japan, 2024)	Self-help & mutual aid among residents Information sharing via social media (SNS)	Deployed maritime & helicopter logistics to reach isolated coastal communities	Infrastructure vulnerability of peninsula regions Need for redundant (backup) transport routes

Real-World Scenarios

Examining recent disaster events and the immediate response mechanisms deployed across diverse geographies.

Case Studies: Japan

Great East Japan (2011) & Noto Peninsula (2024)

- **People's Action:** Swift, orderly self-evacuation to high ground, community shelters, and information sharing via SNS.
- **Government Action:** SDF deployed for rescue operations, utilizing maritime and helicopter logistics.
- **Key Outcomes:** Stricter safety rules, higher sea walls, and debates regarding infrastructure vulnerability in remote areas.



Case Studies: India (Floods)



Kerala (2018) & Uttarakhand (2013)

- **People's Action:** Local fishermen rescued thousands with personal boats. Villagers sheltered stranded pilgrims.
- **Government Action:** Large-scale rescue operations coordinated by the Army, Navy, Air Force, and NDRF.
- **Key Outcomes:** Fishermen honored as "army of the sea". Calls for better Himalayan early-warning systems.

Case Studies: Malaysia

Cyclone Tauktae (2021) & Selangor Floods (2021)

- **People's Action:** Early coastal evacuation.
Fishermen returned to shore proactively and neighbors shared supplies.
- **Government Action:** Crucial pre-landfall evacuation orders, Navy rescues, and specialized evacuation centers.
- **Key Outcomes:** Early warnings kept death tolls low. Renewed focus on upgrading coastal drainage systems.



Q1: 2 Core Similarities



1. Ordinary People Act First

In every country, ordinary people act before official help arrives.

- › **Japan:** Mutual aid during Noto Peninsula earthquake.
- › **India:** Kerala fishermen rescued thousands with personal boats
- › **Malaysia:** Neighbors shared supplies during Selangor floods.



2. Large-Scale Gov't Response

Every government ultimately responds with massive resources.

- › **Japan:** Deployed SDF with helicopter logistics.
- › **India:** Military operations like "Operation Rahat".
- › **Malaysia:** Coordinated pre-landfall evacuations.



Q1: 2 Key Differences



1. Differing Hazards

The specific types of disasters dictate the necessary response.

- › **Japan:** Primarily prepares for sudden seismic events (Earthquakes/Tsunamis).
- › **India & Malaysia:** Manage seasonal and climate-driven events (Floods, Cyclones).



2. The Response Balance

The balance between technology and manpower

varies

- › **Japan:** Leans heavily on expensive, advanced logistics.
- › **India & Malaysia:** Rely heavily on sheer human volume and grassroots efforts.

Q2: Causes of Patterns



1. Geography

Physical landscapes determine the hazards. Japan's fragile peninsulas dictate their vulnerabilities, just as India and Malaysia's river plains and coastlines dictate their flood risks.



2. Economic Capacity

Richer nations like Japan can afford costly maritime and aerial logistics. Developing areas must depend more on direct people-power and local resources.



3. Community Bonds

Strong cultural ties exist globally, which is why grassroots, hands-on help appears universally in all three countries regardless of economic status.



Q3: The Most Important Element



Partnership is Vital

The most crucial element is a strong partnership between government resources and community action.

- **Filling the Gap:** During Kerala floods, gov't resources stretched thin. Local fishermen filled the gap with immediate physical reach.
- **Following Warnings:** Gov't early warning systems (IMD) for Cyclone Tauktae succeeded because the community actively partnered by evacuating.

Q4: Actionable Steps for Preparedness

4

Crucial Steps



Act Decisively Follow official warnings early—just like the successful pre-landfall evacuations during Cyclone Tauktae.



Participate Actively Join organized community initiatives, such as India's Apada Mitra volunteer scheme.



Share Information Establish communication plans and use SNS to share vital info, as seen in the Noto Peninsula.



Know Your Risks Identify local hazards (floods, cyclones, or earthquakes) and map out evacuation routes.

Conclusion

Community Participation in Action

Ultimately, community participation turns ordinary people into first responders. While official teams navigate damaged infrastructure, it is the local network that provides the immediate lifeline.



Questions?

Thank you for your attention to our analysis.

Presented by: Harsh, Rudra, Aishath, Suzuki, Yamamoto, Fukuda, Okada, & Sumida

Image Sources



<https://img.turkiyetoday.com/images/2025/02/sar.jpg>

Source: www.turkiyetoday.com



<https://vikalpsangam.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/01/K-A-Shaji-Art-as-a-tool-exhibit-.jpeg>

Source: vikalpsangam.org



<https://nexttravelsrilanka.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/12/30-Cyclone-Ditwah-Flood-and-its-Aftermath-in-Sri-Lanka.jpg>

Source: nexttravelsrilanka.com



Thumbnail
for

<https://www.zakat.org/img/asset/cHVibGljLzlwMjUvMDcvYmFubmVyLWFuZC1ob21lLXBhZ2UtanVtYm90cm9uLXNsaWRlci1pbWFnZS5qcGc/banner-and-home-page-jumbotr-on-slider-image.jpg?w=960&h=540&fit=crop&fm=webp&q=60&filt=0&s=ec34012ba2a47e5f53ae13acab35bcf2>

Source: www.zakat.org



www.zakat.org

https://cdn.redcross.ca/prodmedia/crc/azure/homeslides/campaign/26tiffanycirclematch_hp_1400x600.jpg?ext=.jpg

Source: www.redcross.ca